

Seq66 v. 0.99.28 MIDI Learn with the Akai MPK Mini Play

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1 Introduction

This document is a tutorial about using the MIDI Learn feature of *Seq66*. It supplements the "MIDI Learn" section of the user manual with a real case.

The following projects support *Seq66* and its documentation (see the **Help** menu):

- <https://github.com/ahlstromcj/seq66.git>
- <https://ahlstromcj.github.io/>
- <https://ahlstromcj.github.io/docs/seq66/akai-mpk-mini-play-learn.pdf>

1.1 Background

The Akai MPK Mini Play Mk3 is an interesting device. It has a full-fledged MIDI engine, but uses an ARM processor that constrains what can be done with it. The following article explains how it works.

<http://sandsoftwaresound.net/akai-mpk-mini-play-midi-implementation/>

When attached via USB, channel 10 is used for percussion, all other channels respond to notes, but all program change events are redirection to channel 1. For *Seq66* and MIDI, what matters is that the MIDI controller portion of the emits events only on channels 1 and 10. Also, the ARM mini-controller filters out all SysEx other than its own.

1.2 Setup

Plug in the MPK Mini. Run *Seq66* and verify that it is active in the **Edit / Preferences / MIDI Clock** and **MIDI Input** tabs and the The setup involves the following steps:

1. Create a 'ctrl' file.
2. Specify it and activate it in the 'rc' file.
3. Set the MPK Mini as an input controller.

1.2.1 Setup / 'ctrl' File

Copy the `data/linux/qseq66.ctrl` to a file named after the device, such as `akai-mpk-mini-play.ctrl`. Copy this file to "\$home", which is usually `/.config/seq66`.

Read up on the '*ctrl*' File section of the user manual to get familiar with the control sections of this file. The sections relevant to MIDI Learn are

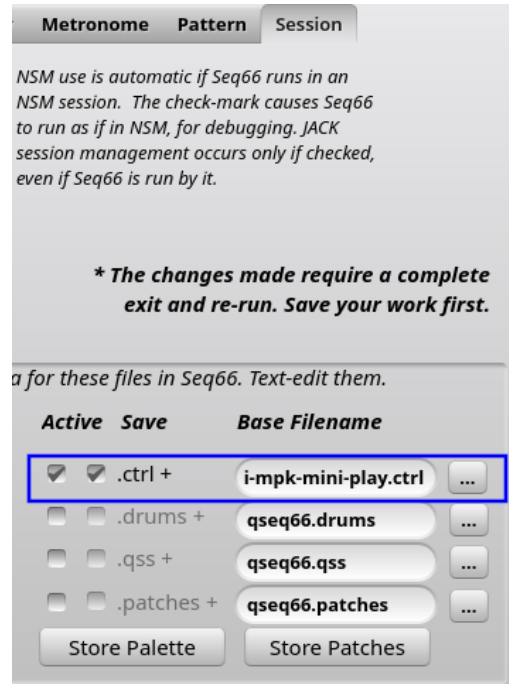
```
[comments]
[loop-control]
[mute-group-control]
[automation-control]
```

Only the comments section needs editing (for an explanation of the intended usage of the file). The rest are covered by the **Edit / Preferences / Session** tab and the **Learn** dialog, though the 'ctrl' can still be edited, if desired.

At this point, the 'ctrl' file is in place, but not yet ready.

1.2.2 Setup / 'rc' File

In the **Edit / Preferences / Session** tab, set up the new 'ctrl' file as shown here.



Set New 'ctrl' File

Note that it is marked as active and to be saved. Exit *Seq66*. In the 'rc' file `/.config/seq66/qseq66.rc`, one should see the following items (adapted to one's personal setup):

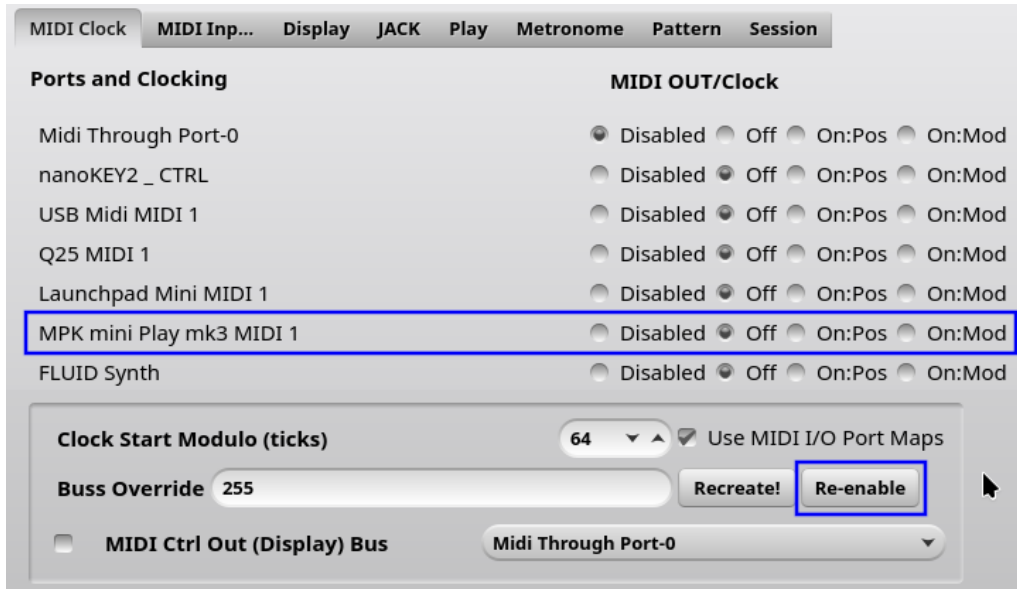
```
[comments]
Add your comment block here

[midi-control-file]
active = true
name = "akai-mpk-mini-play.ctrl"
```

Now restart *Seq66*. The changes made in the next section will now be able to be written to the 'ctrl' file.

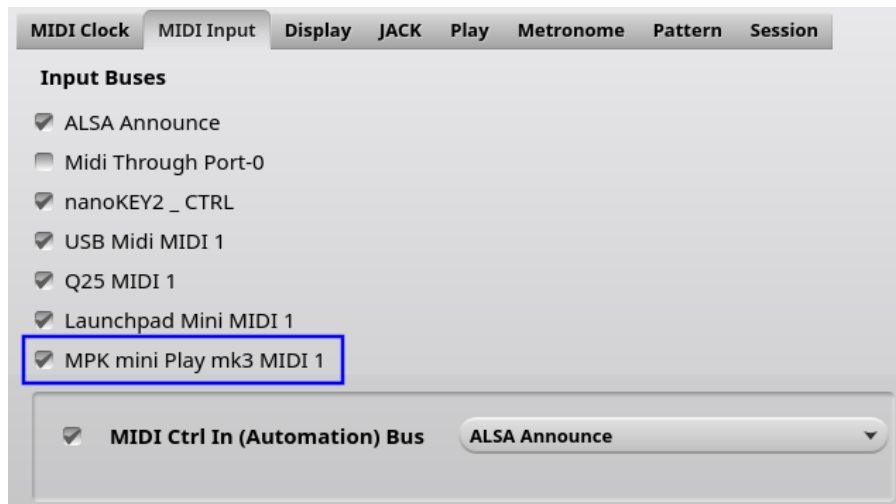
1.2.3 Setup / I/O Ports

Refer to the following figures.



Set MPK Mini Output Status

Some ports might be disabled, even though present, because they were missing. If it is known they are plugged in click, click the **Re-enable** button. This also enables the input port entries in the **MIDI Input** tab. Set the MPK Mini controller as desired (usually Disabled or Off).



Set MPK Mini Input Status

Make sure the MPK Mini is enabled. Do not set **MIDI Ctrl In** at this time. Restart *Seq66* and verify that the MIDI clock and input tabs show the correct settings.

In the 'rc' file `/.config/seq66/qseq66.rc`, one should see the following items (adapted to one's personal setup):

```
[midi-input]
...
```

```

6 1 "[6] 48:0 MPK mini Play mk3 MIDI 1"

[midi-input-map]
1      # map is active
. . .
6 1 "MPK mini Play mk3 MIDI 1"

[midi-clock]
. . .
5 0 "[5] 48:0 MPK mini Play mk3 MIDI 1"

[midi-clock-map]
1      # map is active
5 0 "MPK mini Play mk3 MIDI 1"

```

If not, this is an issue and should be reported. In the meantime, one can try to edit the 'rc' file.

1.2.4 Setup / I/O and Automation Control

Once all the ports are configured, one can then select the MPK Mini as the control/automation buss.



Set MPK Mini Input as the MIDI Controller

In the 'ctrl' file `/.config/seq66/akai-mpk-mini-play.ctrl`, one should see the following items (adapted to one's personal setup):

```

[midi-control-settings]
control-buss = "MPK mini Play mk3 MIDI 1"
midi-enabled = true

[midi-control-out-settings]
output-buss = "MPK mini Play mk3 MIDI 1"
midi-enabled = false

```

1.3 MIDI Learning

TODO